

1) Top Priority: 1 Major Policy Research - Safety “ Sidewalk, infrastructure, markings, (Housing Issues) After

IRVINE SAFE RIDE (Initiative)

2) Present a proposal to the Irvine City Council
3 minute - presentation (Regulations on E-Bikes)

Poster
Original Policy

A Policy Proposal to Improve E-Bike Safety for Students and Residents

Evidence:
Use age restrictions, biological developments

- 1) Define the problems:
 - a) Riders travel at unsafe speeds
 - b) Inconsistent helmet use
 - c) They have very little knowledge of traffic laws
 - d) E-bikes have been getting more unsafe to go on trail paths.
 - e) Parents purchase high powered e-bikes; thus, endangering pedestrians
 - f) Difficulty to enforce them.
 - g) Dangers of accidents and crashes

Personal Experience

- 2) Define Policy Goals

Primary Goal - Reduce the e-bikes injuries of students by ?% within 2 years.

Secondary Goals - Encourage public transportation, improve public safety and e-bike safety

3) Table Research

Option	Safety	Cost	Ease of Implementation	Political Feasibility

Student safety education	high	Cost -effort	high	high
Protected bike lanes	high	high	medium	Medium - maybe hard
Increased enforcement (permit)	Medium			
App design for crowdsource report e-bikes/safety				
Ban certain e-bikes (high powered ones)				

Build a Balanced Proposal

Pillar 1: Infrastructure

Protected bike lanes, especially near schools.
 Better intersection markings.
 Improving lighting for visibility
 Dedicated crossing in high traffic areas

Pillar 2: Education

Annual E-bike safety workshops
 Student riding certification
 Parent information sessions

Pillar 4: Incentives

Discounts for helmet through local shops,
 Raise foot traffic, but also increase safety, helps the city build better communities

Pillar 5: Data

Annual public safety report
 Reporting crash locations on map
 Regular evaluation of which interventions are working.

Option: **Website**, but offering E-Bike Safety + DARE but with E Bikes

Draft of Speech (3 Minute about the safety)

Delivery of the speech:

Good news first: Irvine already moved on this. In January–February 2026 the Council introduced **Ordinance No. 26-05**, amending Division 7 of Title 4 of the Municipal Code, and in that same window Police Chief Michael Kent told the Council that the 13 to 16-year-old age range is involved in about half of all bicycle collisions in the city, and 69% of those collisions involved an e-bike. The council voted 6-1 to advance measures holding parents more accountable and setting new speed limits on sidewalks and trails, and Mayor Agran called it "a full-blown crisis". This matters for your project two ways: it gives you real, current evidence to cite, and it tells you where the *gaps* are — the ordinance is mostly enforcement/regulation. Your "Irvine Safe Ride" pitch should position itself as the education + infrastructure + data half that the Council hasn't fully funded yet, not a duplicate of what already passed.

Pathways forward, weighed for Irvine specifically

1. Education campaign ("Safe Ride" workshops + school certification)

- *Pros*: Cheap relative to infrastructure, easy to pilot with one school district (IUSD) first, popular with parents, aligns with the new state law requiring cited minors to complete a CHP safety course — you can propose Irvine's program as the *proactive* version of that reactive requirement.
- *Cons*: Hard to measure impact quickly; voluntary workshops have low turnout unless tied to an incentive (e.g., discount or registration requirement).
- *Feasibility*: High. This is the easiest ask for Council — low cost, no political fight.

2. Infrastructure (protected lanes, crossings, lighting near schools)

- *Pros*: Addresses root cause (unsafe road design), has long-term payoff, fits Irvine's existing bike-master-plan language.
- *Cons*: Expensive, multi-year timeline, requires capital budget approval — not something you win in a 3-minute pitch.
- *Feasibility*: Medium-low short term. Good as a "phase 2" ask — frame it as "study and pilot one corridor," not a citywide overhaul.

3. Stronger enforcement / permitting

- *Pros*: Already politically viable — Council just did this with 26-05.

- *Cons:* You'd be redundant if you re-propose enforcement; also risks the "over-policing minors" pushback that Councilmember Carroll raised when he was the lone no vote, objecting to sidewalk speed limits.
- *Feasibility:* Already happening — don't spend your pitch time here.

4. Crowdsourced safety-reporting app

- *Pros:* Cheap (could pilot on an existing platform like SeeClickFix), generates the crash-location data pillar you already listed, gives residents a sense of agency.
- *Cons:* Needs a champion to maintain it or it dies after launch; data quality depends on adoption.
- *Feasibility:* Medium. A strong "innovative but low-cost" ask that differentiates your proposal.

5. Helmet/safety-gear incentives

- *Pros:* Popular, cheap, easy local-business partnership (bike shops, REI), good visual for a poster/campaign.
- *Cons:* Doesn't address speed or road design — a nice-to-have, not a fix.
- *Feasibility:* High, but frame as supporting pillar, not the headline.

6. Ban high-powered e-bikes for minors

- *Pros:* Directly targets Chief Kent's stated problem (high-powered bikes purchased by parents).
- *Cons:* Politically hardest — enforcement is a nightmare, and the state (AB 544) is already moving on classification; a local ban could conflict with state preemption on vehicle classification.
- *Feasibility:* Low as a standalone ask. Better framed as "support state enforcement + require dealer disclosure of bike class at point of sale."

7. Change.org petition as a pressure campaign

- *Pros:* Cheap, shows community support number before you even speak, easy to attach to your speech ("1,200 residents signed...").
- *Cons:* Low signal on its own — Council has heard petitions before and can ignore them without real ask attached.
- *Feasibility:* Use it as a supporting tool, not your main ask.

My recommendation for your 3-minute pitch: lead with the crash statistics (they're the strongest thing you have), position your ask as filling the education + infrastructure + data gaps in 26-05 — not competing with it — and make one concrete, low-cost ask (pilot workshop + crowdsource reporting app) rather than the whole five-pillar list. Councils fund small pilots much more easily than five-part programs.

Speech draft (~2.5 minutes, ~340 words)

Good evening, Mayor Agran and Councilmembers.

My name is Adriana, and I'm here today because I've watched e-bikes become both a lifeline and a liability on our streets.

Last November, Chief Kent told this Council something that should stop us all: teenagers aged 13 to 16 make up half of all bicycle collisions in Irvine — and 69% of those crashes involve an e-bike. This isn't a hypothetical. This is happening in our neighborhoods, near our schools, on the trails our families use every weekend.

I want to thank this Council for Ordinance 26-05. Setting speed limits and holding parents accountable was the right call, and I don't stand here to undo that work. I stand here because enforcement alone won't finish the job. You can set a speed limit, but if a twelve-year-old has never been taught how to read traffic, or if the intersection near their school has no protected crossing, **that spells a huge problem for our Irvine community.**

That's why I'm proposing the **Irvine Safe Ride Initiative**: a low-cost pilot in e-bike safety.

A partnership with IUSD to bring e-bike safety workshops into one school this fall — teaching the traffic laws and riding skills that no one currently requires before a fourteen-year-old gets on a 500-watt bike.

Irvine has already shown it's willing to lead on e-bike safety. While the initiatives have been passed in February of this year, I hope to see the next step towards securing our youth's safety. I'm asking you to lead on the other half of the problem: not just enforcing safety, but teaching it.

Thank you for your time, and I'm happy to answer any questions.

(2nd OPTION is to include [Change.org](https://change.org))

Executive Summary

The Problem

Why Education Matters

Proposed Program

Step 2:

Data and figure out images and brochures, and posters